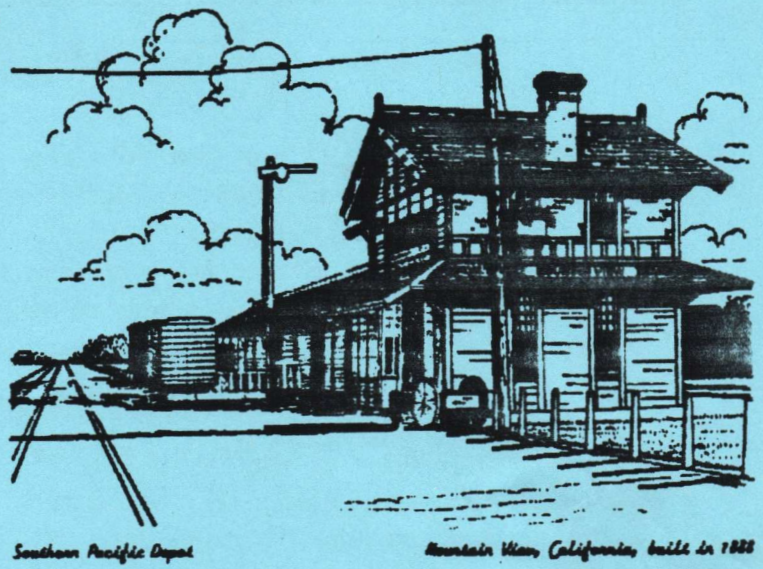
MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION NEWSLETTER

P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042

Hilton U. Brown, III - Editor



BARBEQUE & RAFFLE
The August Meeting

The Sunday, August 4, 1996 meeting of the Mountain View Historical Association will be our ***Third Annual Barbecue & Raffle***. Note that the venue has changed this year. We will be meeting in the Atrium area outside our usual meeting room at the Mountain View Senior Center.

We are required by our by-laws to elect a Nominating Committee at the August meeting. The function of the Nominating Committee is to present at the Annual Meeting in November Nominees for each office of the Association. The Nominating Committee will consist of three members of the Association. The President will present a slate for your consideration, but nominations from the membership will of course be accepted. It is expected that this bit of business will take no more than five minutes.

Page three of this Newsletter provides the details concerning the ***Barbecue & Raffle***. Judged by the previous two events, this will be a great success! *GOOD FOOD!, GOOD COMPANY!, A GOOD TIME!*

Don't miss this opportunity to socialize! Read page three and get your check in the mail! See you Sunday, August 4!

AGRICULTURE
in the
SANTA CLARA VALLEY
The May Meeting

The May meeting was the first of series highlighting the agricultural past of our area. Mountain View Historical Association Vice President Arthur Walton gave an interesting, informative and data filled presentation discussing the early days of agriculture in the area. He discussed the vineyards and truck farms which once dominated the Santa Clara valley, and the residents of Portuguese and Italian extraction who were the farmers and workers of the area.

Our reckless destruction of the environment of the Valley of Heart's Desire was an important theme. The water table in the valley had dropped 200 feet before the creation of the Water District in 1929. We have paved over a large fraction of what once once the most productive agricultural area on the continent. The once pristine air is now often smoggy, and the beautiful vistas of orchards in bloom are only remnants.

Future meetings will carry on the agricultural theme and bring it up to the present.

IN MEMORIAM

Florence Wright Berger - in Palo Alto May 12, 1996. Born April 10, 1907 in Mountain View to William P. and Nellie (Swall) Wright. Widow of the late Earl C. Berger, she is survived by three daughters, including Honor Spitz of the Mountain View Historical Association. "Was a lover of art, travel, gardening and chocolate."

Mary C. Ferguson - in Mtn. View May 17, 1996. Born 1915 in Lafayette, IN. She is survived by her husband John (61 years), four children, seven grandchildren and one great grandchild. Mary was a resident of Los Altos for 44 years, served as reference librarian at the Los Altos Library, and as librarian in charge of the Pioneer Room at the Mountain View Library.

Marie Bianchi Hugo - in San Jose May 20, 1996. Born 1903 in San Francisco. The Bianchi family ran the Union Hotel on Castro Street. Marie Bianchi married Merrill S. Hugo in 1931 at Stanford Memorial Church. Both were teachers and the family home was on Mariposa Avenue. They were charter members of the Historical Association and active in the organization until Mr. Hugo's death a number of years ago. Mrs. Hugo is survived by two sons, grandchildren and great grandchildren.

Barbara de Curtoni Welch - in Mountain View June 16, 1996. Born 1920 in Mountain View, she attended the local schools and graduated from Mountain View High School in 1937. She is survived by her husband James J. Welch (55 years), a son and two grandchildren. Barbara helped organize class reunions for classes that graduated 50 or more years ago. She was a member of the Mountain View Historical Association.

Laura Navarro Laut - in Santa Cruz June 30, 1996. Born 1920 in Mountain View. She attended local schools and then worked as a beautician for Charles Brown. Before moving to Aptos she was employed by the First Interstate Bank in Mountain View. Survived by husband Paul W. Laut (54 years), two children, four grandchildren, three sisters and a brother. She was a member of the Mountain View Historical Association.

Annie Budesa - in Los Altos June 13, 1996. Born 1905 in Croatia. Widow of the late Matt Budesa, she is survived by a daughter, two grandchildren and many nieces and nephews. Her daughter is Mrs. Edna Pear, a member of the Mountain View Historical Association.

MEMORIAL BOOK

We now have a Memorial Book in the Pioneer Room.

Anyone wishing to commemorate the memory of a loved one or friend who has passed away may make a donation to the Mountain View Historical Association and the name of the deceased and the donor will be inscribed in the Memorial Book.

The book is attractive and tasteful, and the memorial pages are graceful and dignified. The book will attract the attention of visitors to the Pioneer room, and will recall the past and passing of our friends and benefactors.

Memorial Forms are available at the Pioneer Room, or call Edna Thompson at 415-967-3116.

MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

BARBECUE & RAFFLE

SUNDAY, AUGUST 4, 1996 - 1:00 P.M.

NEW LOCATION: ***SENIOR CENTER***
266 ESQUELA AVE
MTN. VIEW, CA 94042

Menu:

Zesty Hamburgers
Condiments
Garden Fresh Green Salad
Art's Own Potato Salad
Baked Beans
Apple Pie

Cost:

Adults	$ 8.00 each
Children	$ 5.00 each
Raffle tickets	
	$ 1.00 each
or 6 for	$ 5.00

Bring your own:

Table Settings
Beverages

Agenda:

1:00 PM	Registration
2:00 PM	Barbecue
3:25 PM	Business (brief)
3:30 PM	Raffle

Approximate times)

DETACH HERE AND RETURN FORM BELOW

BARBECUE ORDER FORM

Send This Form With Your Check to:
MVHA BARBECUE
P.O. BOX 252
MNT. VIEW, CA 94042

YOUR NAME: _____
TELEPHONE NUMBER

NAMES OF GUESTS: _____

NUMBER OF ADULTS _____ @ $ 8.00 = $ _____

NUMBER OF CHILDREN _____ @ $ 5.00 = $ _____

TOTAL AMOUNT ENCLOSED $ _____

Please Mail By:
July 26, 1996
Thank You

OLD NEWSPAPER ITEMS
Noted by Barbara Kinchen

100 YEARS AGO (1896): The Cyclers' Club owned its building, a fine piano, billiard and pool tables, and had over 50 members.

Onion seed growers estimated they would have about half the usual crop because of the prolonged hot weather the first part of July.

Republicans from throughout the county marched along the streets of Mountain View, led by the band from Palo Alto. Members of the local McKinley Club "made their first appearance with their new torches." Olympic Hall was crowded with an enthusiastic audience, "many of whom were ladies."

75 YEARS AGO (1921): The Altamont Creamery opened on Castro Street, opposite the Post Office, and its fresh-made butter sold at 45¢ for one pound and 90¢ for a square (two pounds).

"We want an alert office boy." "Yes sir," said the applicant for the job. "Are you alert?" "No, sir, I'm Aleck."

The Minton Company had 60 men on its payroll and would employ more if the plant would expand.

All aliens had to register. Leon Watson, jeweler, handled the job locally and reported that of the 400 registered, half were Japanese.

50 YEARS AGO (1946): Salaries were raised by $400 a year for Mountain View High School's teaching staff of 32. This boosted the lowest paid teacher from $2,300 per year to $2,700.

Ferry-Morse bought the 14-acre Curtis ranch, at the corner of Alviso Road and Front Street (now Evelyn) for raising seed and warehousing crops from other large holdings throughout the state.

The Resister Leader started publishing three issues a week instead of two. It cost $3.50 delivered, for one year!!!

Women workers were needed at the Knudsen Frozen Food Plant, Mariposa Avenue at the railroad tracks.

"Wanta Buy A Blimp?" There was one for sale at Moffett Field for $7,500 - 147 feet long, 47 feet wide, 54 feet high, filled with helium and ready to fly.

25 YEARS AGO (1971): A new Lucky store opened at 711 El Camino Real.

Castro Street Teen Post, 301 Castro Street, offered activities and counseling for Mountain View's Mexican-American youth.

The Sweet Sioux Baton Corps, sponsored by Parks and Recreation Department, won second place at the San Mateo County Fair Baton Twirling Tournament.

A rattlesnake escaped from a home aquarium, bit a Labrador dog which barked and awoke the owner. He was bitten and, in turn, bit the snake just behind its head. The snake died, the dog died and the owner was in intensive care at El Camino Hospital.

Mountain View's First Presbyterian Church celebrated the 120th anniversary of its founding. It has occupied four different buildings at three different sites.

DID YOU FORGET TO PAY YOUR 1996 DUES?

Look at the mailing label on this Newsletter and if there is a red number on the label, you forgot! Any questions? Call (415)967-3116. Thank you! Edna Thompson, Membership Chairperson.

NEW TO THE PIONEER ROOM
Reported by Barbara Kinchen

From Joe Sweeney - "The Making of Silicon Valley: A One Hundred Year Renaissance", Ward Winslow editor and published by the Santa Clara Valley Historical Association. It has 19 chapters relating the history of Silicon Valley, many photos and an excellent index.

From Lennart Ahlkvist - A small four-page brochure written by Louis Hirschbek about 1930 stating some of his religious beliefs and describing several religious dreams. Mr. Hirschbek was a baker and violin maker in Mountain View.

Also in the Pioneer Room - Boxes of stationery with an excellent sketch of the Adobe Building. Proceeds to go to the ***Save the Adobe Task Force.***

NEW TV/VCR CABINET
Built by Ben DeBolt

The Save The Adobe Task Force, under the auspices of Ben DeBolt has developed a "Speaker's Presentation Kit" for use in persuading the residents of Mountain View to support Saving the Adobe. A part of the kit is a Video Tape. To show the tape, a portable VCR/Monitor was required, so Ben saw to procuring an appropriate machine. (Incidentally, the Pioneer Room has long needed better facilities for viewing the tapes in the archives.) So with all of this going on, Ben found the time to build a cabinet to store the TV/VCR and to store the tapes. So once more, the Library, the Pioneer Room, the Mountain View Historical Association, and the Save The Adobe Task Force owe Ben our thanks! Thank You Ben DeBolt!

EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE MEETING
June 12, 1996

The Executive Committee of the Mountain View Historical Association met on June 12, 1996 in the Pioneer Room at City Hall. The Treasurer's Report is presented elsewhere in this Newsletter. The current membership status is also reported elsewhere in this Newsletter.

The Mountain View Visual Arts Committee will assist in preserving and displaying historical materials in the Pioneer Room.

Planning for the annual Barbecue & Raffle, scheduled for August 4, was the major business of the meeting.

Wally Erichsen reported on the proceedings of the ***Save The Adobe Task Force***. Monthly meetings are being held. A Save The Adobe Speaker's Kit has been prepared. Volunteers will participate in various community events to raise money and increase citizen awareness.

A Nominating Committee must be elected at the August meeting to draft a slate of officers for the November election of Association Officers.

As is noted elsewhere in this Newsletter, a "Memorial Book" has been established in the Pioneer Room to record memorials as may be appropriate.

Copies of the Minutes of the Executive Committee Meetings may be obtained from the Secretary or from the Newsletter Editor.

SAVE THE ADOBE TASK FORCE

MISSION STATEMENT

The mission of the "Save the Adobe" Task Force is to restore and preserve Mountain View's historic Adobe Building for use as a vital community resource.

Task Force Main Committee

Wally Erichsen (Chair)
Ann Bakotich
Hilton Brown
Ben DeBolt
Eva Mockbee
Bob Schatz
Honor Spitz
Edna Thompson
Kassandra Winder

The Task Force meets on a regular monthly basis and ad hoc subcommittees meet as required. What is needed now is a show of broad-based community support to restore and preserve the adobe building.

To Accomplish This, The Task Force Plans:

- To use community media to inform and create civic interest
- To request service clubs and other community groups to allow a brief presentation by our speakers bureau
- To circulate a "Petition of Support" around town to allow citizen response
- To ask people to state what their vision for the use of the Adobe might be for themselves, their families and their organizations.

How can you help?

- The Speakers Bureau is ready! If you belong to an organization that would like to hear about the Old Adobe, call Ben Debolt at 968-3404 to arrange for a presentation.
- If you are willing to contribute time, help is needed to staff booths at public affairs, circulate petitions, pass out flyers, etc. Contact Wally Erichsen at 948-2644, or any member of the task force to volunteer.
- You can buy supplies of note paper and stationery with the Adobe drawing at the Pioneer Room. This serves in two ways, it advertises and it produces revenue, which is needed for the production of materials.
- Talk it up! We need to convince all of our City Officials that the residents of Mountain View really want the Adobe restored and preserved!
- If you have ideas or suggestions that will further the cause, get them to the task force members.

MEMBERSHIP REPORT

As of July 1, 1996

Reported by Edna Thompson

A list of all members of the Mountain View Historical Association is available from the Chair of the Membership Committee or from the Newsletter Editor.
Dues are $7.00 per year for an individual or $10.00 per year for a family and Life Membership is $100.00 per person.

Below is a tally by class of membership, and the names of new members.

Life Members	40
Special Members	2
Honored Member	1
Individual Members	108
New 1, Trans. or Disc. 2	
Family Memberships	49
New 1	
Total Memberships	200
Total Members	249

New Members (Since the last Newsletter)

Life Member	Lawrence Anderson
Family Members	Alfred P. & Dolores Chasuk
Member	H. Lee Stillens

Life Members

(Those marked * are new life members in 1996)

Mario Ambra*
Lawrence Anderson*
Lorena Anderson
Dena K. Bonnell
Reynolds Camp
Cliff Del Carlo
Ruth Erichsen*
Wallace Erichsen
Carmen Faravelli
Roger Fellows
Patricia Figueroa
Marion Grimm
Estelle Stagg Heffelfinger
Bill Henderson
Charles Hirschbek*
DeWitt Hogle
Norene Hogle*
George Holden
George Jagels
Al Jehning
John W. Kirby
Joe Kleitman
Helen Shearer Krogh
Holly Urban Moore Leonard*
Kenneth Richard Malovos*
Madeline Chargin Malovos*
Eva Mockbee
Gail Urban Moore
Mimi Mourkas
Patricia J. Reyburn
Elaine Marcetti Shearer
Martin J. Spangler
Honor Spitz
Linda Swan
Joseph Sweeney
Roberta Sweeney
Edna Thompson
Sally Moore Taboada*
John Viscovich
Bill Wissell

ASSOCIATION OFFICERS AND BOARD

President	Ralph Faravelli
Past President & Social	Wally Erichsen
Vice President & Program	Arthur Walton
Secretary	Eva Mockbee
Treasurer	June de Larios
Membership	Edna Thompson
Newsletter & Publicity	Hilton Brown
Hospitality	Mary Esther Walton
Memorials/Remembrances	Edna Thompson
Ways & Means	Joseph Sweeney
Historical Data	Barbara Kinchen
Amplification & Recording	Albert Jehning

Regular meetings of the Mountain View Historical Association are held on the first Sunday of February, May, August and November. The Newsletter is mailed approximately two weeks before each meeting. Deadline for copy for the Newsletter is the third Sunday before each meeting. Short items on appropriate topics, submitted by any member of the Association will be considered for publication.

TREASURER'S REPORT

April 1996 - June 1996

As Reported by June de Larios

Balance 4/1/96		$ 7,680.13
Income:		
Membership	$ 117.00	
Adobe fund	584.00	
Interest	19.39	
Sales	14.00	
Memorial Fund	75.00	
Total		$ 809.39
Expenses:		
Administration	$ 81.78	
Newsletter	240.04	
Adobe fund	1,063.96	
Total:		$ 1,385.78
Balance 6/30/96		$7,103.74
Fund Balances 3/31/96		
Adobe Fund	$ 1,590.04	
Life Member Fund	4,000.00	
Memorial Fund	75.00	
Uncommitted General	1,438.70	
Total Funds		$7,103.74

MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

Third Annual
Barbecue & Raffle

Sunday, August 4, 1996
1:00 PM

New Location

Mountain View Senior Center
266 Escuela Avenue

MEMBERSHIP

Any person who signifies interest in the aims of this Association and who pays the specified annual dues may become a member of the Association.

AIMS The aims of this Association are: To gather and preserve historical data relative to the early settlement and development of the area in and around the present City of Mountain View; to collect, record, edit and publish a history of the pioneering activities of this area; to preserve historic objects and places. To cooperate with other organizations in the Santa Clara Valley on projects deemed worthy by our membership.

MEMBERSHIP APPLICATION

NAME _____

ADDRESS _____

_____

TELEPHONE _____

NEW ___ RENEWAL ___ Regular Membership $7.00/yr
Family Membership $10.00/yr - Life Membership $100.00
Make Check Payable and mail to:
Mountain View Historical Association
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042

Mountain View
Historical Association
P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042





FIRST CLASS MAIL

